	CODE OF ETHICS AND BUSINESS CONDUCT	
	Document no: ASMS Doc 8.2-02	
Compiled by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	
Approved by:	**Management team**	

It is designed to align with international laboratory standards (like ISO/IEC 17025) and professional scientific bodies (such as SACNASP), balancing commercial growth with uncompromising scientific integrity.

1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this Code of Ethics is to define the core values and ethical standards that govern all operations, decisions, and professional relationships at **Azuresky Pty Ltd**.

This policy applies to all directors, permanent employees, temporary staff, and independent contractors acting on behalf of the company. Adherence to this code is the conditions of employment and professional engagement.

2. Core Principles

2.1 Scientific Integrity and Objectivity

As a technical and analytical services provider, our data is our currency. We commit to absolute accuracy, precision, and honesty in all scientific and technical endeavors.

- **Unbiased Reporting:** Technical findings, test results, proficiency testing reporting and reference material certificates must be reported accurately, objectively, and without distortion, regardless of the desired or expected outcome.
- **Prohibition of Data Manipulation:** Under no circumstances will data be fabricated, falsified, selectively omitted, or manipulated to achieve a specific result or to accommodate commercial pressures.

2.2 Independence and Impartiality

Our reputation relies on our independence. We ensure that our technical judgment is never compromised by commercial, financial, or personal pressures

- **Undue Influence:** Staff must not allow customer demands, operational timelines, or financial incentives to influence the validity or objectivity of technical testing and analysis.
- **Conflict of Interest:** Employees must declare any personal, financial, or professional relationships that could create—or appear to create—a conflict of interest with our clients or the integrity of our testing.

2.3 Quality and Professional Competence

We are dedicated to maintaining the highest standards of technical excellence.

- **Compliance with Standards:** All operations will be conducted in strict accordance with relevant national and international standards, standard operating procedures (SOPs), and regulatory frameworks (including ISO/IEC 17025, 17034 and 17043 principles).
- **Continuous Improvement:** We support our technical team in maintaining professional certifications, continuous professional development (CPD), and upholding the codes of conduct of recognized scientific councils. (Only in theory. Practical part of the above statement has not been fulfilled).

3. Workplace and Labor Standards

3.1 Mutual Respect and Dignity

We are committed to fostering a safe, inclusive, and professional working environment as our team grows.

- **Fair Treatment:** Every employee and director will be treated with dignity and respect. Discrimination, harassment, or bullying of any kind—based on race, gender, nationality, or any other ground—is strictly prohibited.
- **Fair Labor Practices:** We commit to transparent, fair, and compliant payroll, working hours, and employment practices in accordance with national labor laws.

3.2 Health, Safety, and Environment (HSE)

Because our technical work occurs both in standalone facilities and on active client operational sites (such as mines or industrial plants), safety is paramount.

- **Site Safety:** Employees must strictly adhere to all health and safety protocols, wear required PPE and respect the site-specific safety regulations of our clients.
- **Environmental Responsibility:** We commit to the safe handling, storage, and disposal of laboratory chemicals, waste, and samples to minimize our environmental footprint.
- **There are no safety packs, files & procedures and so forth in place.** We can only talk about this in detail once they are in place.

4. Client and Commercial Relations

4.1 Confidentiality and Data Protection

In the course of our technical testing, we gain access to proprietary client information, operational data, and strategic insights.

- **Information Security:** All client data, test results, and business operations must be treated as strictly confidential. No employee may disclose proprietary information to third parties without explicit authorization.

- **Data Privacy:** We handle all business and personal data in compliance with relevant data protection legislation (e.g., POPIA).

4.2 Fair Competition and Anti-Bribery

We win business based on the quality of our technical expertise and services, never through unethical practices.

- **Bribery and Corruption:** We enforce a zero-tolerance policy for bribery, kickbacks, or inappropriate facilitation payments.
- **Gifts and Hospitality:** Employees may not accept or offer gifts, meals, or entertainment that could be perceived as trying to improperly influence a business decision or technical outcome.

5. Compliance and Governance

5.1 Accurate Record-Keeping and Financial Integrity

Transparency in our administration is just as critical as transparency in our laboratory notebooks.

- **Business Records:** All financial transactions, inventory logs, asset registers, and tax submissions must be accurate, complete, and fully compliant with statutory requirements.
- **Traceability:** Technical records must be maintained to ensure full traceability of samples, equipment calibrations, and analyst inputs.

5.2 Reporting Violations (Whistleblowing)

Employees have a duty to protect the company's integrity. If an employee witnesses a breach of this code—particularly regarding data falsification, safety violations, or financial misconduct—they are expected to report it immediately to management.

- **Non-Retaliation:** The company guarantees that no employee will suffer reprisal, discrimination, or disciplinary action for reporting a suspected ethical violation in good faith.

6. Adoption and Review

This policy was formally adopted by the Management on 05.06.2026 and will be reviewed annually to ensure it remains relevant to our growing operational scale and evolving regulatory environments.

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Effective Date: 05 June 2026	
Authorised by Management Team	

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06/2026	00	07/2027